

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, January 6, 2026, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne - absent
Ward II Councilor William Greenrose
Ward III Councilor Christopher Irish
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Christopher Cogswell
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski – absent
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Nancy Bates, City Manager

OATH OF OFFICE

City Clerk Melcher swore in Mayor Dale Girard, Assistant Mayor Matteau, Ward II Councilor William Greenrose, Ward III Councilor Christopher Irish, and Councilors at Large Christopher Cogswell, William Limoges, and Wayne Hemingway.

NEW BUSINESS

City Manager Bates would like the Council to approve an ad-hoc committee to review Claremont’s Procurement Policy and appoint three City Councilors to participate and noted the meetings will take place during working hours, the meetings will be open to the public and minutes will be taken. Manager Bates expressed the goal is to review and produce a revised procurement policy document with adoption by the end of April, after adoption the ad-hoc committee will be dissolved.

City Council agrees by consensus to approve this committee.

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Councilor Irish, Councilor Cogswell, and Councilor Greenrose volunteered, and Council agrees.

Manager Bates offered an invitation to two Council members to join a Water Sewer Rate Study Proposal Committee; there are four proposals that have come back to review. This meeting would be during working hours comprised of the City Manager, two Council members, the Water Sewer engineering firm, open to the public for attendance but not for comment as this would not be an official committee, no vote is required to accept one of proposals as the proposals were procured through the City's regular RFP process.

Councilor Cogswell, and councilor Hemingway volunteered, Council agreed.

Mayor Girard read the following letter into record:

Good evening, Assistant Mayor, Members of the City Council, City Manager Bates, Department Heads, City Staff, and Citizens of Claremont.

Tonight marks the beginning of a new City Council term and another chapter in the continued progress of our community. I am deeply grateful for the opportunity to continue serving as Mayor. Representing Claremont — my hometown — is both an honor and a responsibility I approach with humility, pride, and a strong sense of duty.

I want to congratulate each newly elected and returning councilor. Your willingness to step forward in service to this city reflects a commitment not only to leadership, but to the people who call Claremont home. As you take your seats at this table, I encourage you to remember what inspired you to serve — the desire to strengthen our city, to listen, and to make thoughtful decisions that benefit the entire community.

Serving on this Council is not always easy, but it is always important. The decisions we make together shape the quality of life in Claremont today and for generations to come. I have great confidence that this Council will lead with integrity, transparency, and respect.

Claremont stands at an important moment. Over the past several years, we have taken deliberate steps to address long-standing infrastructure needs — projects that had been delayed for far too long. Through careful planning and responsible budgeting, we have begun reinvesting in the core services and facilities that keep our city moving forward. Continuing this work will require focus, cooperation, and a shared commitment to long-term progress.

Each councilor brings a distinct voice, experience, and perspective to this body. Those differences are a strength. When we engage openly, challenge ideas respectfully, and work collaboratively, we make better decisions and serve our residents more effectively.

Our citizens expect — and deserve — professionalism from their elected officials. They are counting on us to listen carefully, communicate openly, and act thoughtfully. When residents reach out, I urge you to respond with respect and consideration, even when opinions differ. Strong communities are built on trust, and trust is built through open communication.

We are fortunate to have talented department heads and dedicated city employees who serve Claremont every day. Their knowledge, experience, and commitment are essential to the success of our city operations. Take the time to listen, ask questions, and learn from their expertise. These individuals are key partners in carrying out the policies and priorities set by this Council.

Preparation is also essential to our success. I encourage each of you to come to meetings well-prepared and informed. Reach out to the City Manager in advance with questions so staff can provide accurate and complete information. Asking questions during meetings is equally important, as it allows the public to better understand the decisions before us.

In April of 2025, we had the opportunity to begin working with **Ms. Bates as Acting City Manager**. Throughout that time, she demonstrated steady leadership, sound judgment, and a genuine ability to bring people together — both within City Hall and across the broader

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community. For these reasons, and with confidence in her leadership, **Ms. Bates was appointed as Claremont's permanent City Manager in December.**

As we move forward, it is important to remember that while disagreement is inevitable, respect is not optional. Every councilor is entitled to an opinion. When votes are divided — as they sometimes will be on a council of nine — the decision of the majority must be respected. Let us focus on the work ahead rather than personal differences, so that this term remains productive and constructive.

In closing, I congratulate each of you on your election and thank you for your willingness to serve. By working together with professionalism, mutual respect, and a shared commitment to Claremont, we can continue building a city we are proud to represent.

Best wishes for a successful and fulfilling term. Thank you.

Appointments of Councilors to Boards and Committees

Airport Advisory Board

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to appoint Mayor Dale Girard to the Airport Advisory Board.

Voice vote:

Irish – yes

Hemingway – yes

Limoges – yes

Matteau – yes

Greenrose - yes

Cogswell – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-0

Claremont Community Television Board

By Consensus Council agrees to move this board to the next meeting.

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Claremont Planning Board

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to appoint Assistant Mayor Matteau to the Planning Board and appoint Councilor Koloski as the alternate.

Voice vote:

Irish – yes

Hemingway – yes

Limoges – yes

Matteau – yes

Greenrose - yes

Cogswell – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-0

Claremont Conservation Committee

A motion was made by Councilor Greenrose and seconded by Councilor Limoges to appoint Councilor Cogswell to the Claremont Conservation Committee.

Voice vote:

Irish – yes

Hemingway – yes

Limoges – yes

Matteau – yes

Greenrose - yes

Cogswell – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-0

Historic District Commission

A motion was made by Councilor Irish and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Councilor Greenrose to the Historic District Commission

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Voice vote:

Irish – yes

Hemingway – yes

Limoges – yes

Matteau – yes

Greenrose - yes

Cogswell – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-0

Policy Committee

By Consensus Council agrees to bring this back at a later date.

Steering Committee for EPA Multipurpose Grant

A motion was made by Councilor Greenrose and seconded by Councilor Irish to appoint Councilor Cogswell to the Steering Committee for EPA Multipurpose Grant.

Councilor Cogswell was just appointed as citizen but will step down to take the Council seat.

Voice vote:

Irish – yes

Hemingway – yes

Limoges – yes

Matteau – yes

Greenrose - yes

Cogswell – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-0

Seat Claremont Arts, History & Culture Resources

Mayor Girard explained Councilor Koloski has been on this committee and has voiced interest in continuing, however, Councilor Koloski would not be able to make attendance if the meeting dates change.

By consensus Council agrees to delay this appointment until the next meeting.

Frances J Tolles Home Board of Trustees

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By consensus Council agrees to delay this appointment until the next meeting.

Energy Advisory Committee

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to appoint Councilor Greenrose to the Energy Advisory Committee.

Voice vote:

Irish – yes

Hemingway – yes

Limoges – yes

Matteau – yes

Greenrose - yes

Cogswell – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-0

ADJOURNMENT

At 6:55 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Irish – yes

Hemingway – yes

Limoges – yes

Matteau – yes

Greenrose - yes

Cogswell – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council